

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

# before-after

Explicit state-change comparison — what was, what is.

## What the manifest refactor produced.

### BEFORE.

35 layouts scattered across one 10,382-line lattice.css monolith. Per-layout rules grepped, not folder-located. No central metadata.



### AFTER.

45 components self-contained at lib/components, one folder each with manifest plus styles plus example plus README. Bundler concatenates per-component CSS; loader exposes the catalog via JSON.

## Three reasons we are building.

### BUILD

The platform is the product. Owning it owns the roadmap.



### WHY NOT BUY

No vendor matches our compliance posture without surrender of control.

### WHY NOT DELAY

Cost of waiting compounds: each quarter spent on workarounds is one fewer quarter on the platform.

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## When NOT to reach for before-after.

**Two competing options.** Use `compare-prose` or `split-compare` when both sides are alternatives under consideration. before-after is for a change that already happened.

**More than two states.** If there is a middle state or a sequence of changes, use `list-steps` to show the progression. before-after is binary by construction.

**Editorial labels on the cards.** The card label is always Before or After. Renaming them to Old way / New way defeats the universal grammar and breaks reader expectations.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

`compare-prose` — two alternatives being weighed, not a transformation

`split-compare` — binary decision with a verdict bar

`redline` — the change is in verbatim text, not structural state

`list-steps` — the change has more than two phases